MERCY'S ANATOMY

Season 2, Episode 1 (Season Premiere)

"Pick Up the Pieces"

Episode 2x01, the Season 2 premiere. The counterpart of *Grey's Anatomy* 2x01. Narrator: Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock

In-story dates: Thursday, September 8, 2005, 7:02 PM (picking up from 1x09) through Sunday, September 11, 2005, 9:07 AM

Script: Cold Open + 5 Acts + Tag. 40 scenes. Standard: MA-009

Depends on MA-001 through MA-011 and episodes 1x01-1x09

EPISODE PDF PACKAGE (MA-009 §6): 1. Title page and cast (with ages on Friday, September 9, 2005). 2. Script. 3. Media Companion. 4. Continuity Sheet.

Cast in Order of Appearance (Ages on Friday, September 9, 2005)

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Dr. Marc-Anthony Bullock	Surgical Intern (narrator)	Jan 5, 1979	26
Dr. Clayton Hartwell	Fetal Surgeon; Esther's husband	Mar 3, 1971	34
Dr. Esther Smilley	Surgical Intern	Sep 20, 1979	25
Dr. Natasha Donohue	Chief of Surgery	Jun 2, 1958	47
Yolanda Price	Patient: TTTS laser	Mar 30, 1974	31
FF Darnell Price	Yolanda's husband	Jun 11, 1972	33
Dr. Harmony Divine	Surgical Intern	Jun 19, 1979	26
Dr. Arianna Cummings	Surgical Intern	Oct 25, 1979	25
Russell Jeffries	Elxa's husband	Apr 3, 1975	30
Dr. Elxa Bullock	Surgical Resident (18 weeks pregnant)	Aug 29, 1977	28
Lamont 'Monty' Gaines	Owner, Monty's on Jackson	Oct 10, 1962	42
Dr. Raven Ellison	Surgical Intern	Dec 3, 1979	25
Dr. Amond Baker	Surgical Intern	Feb 10, 1979	26
Dr. Robert Bullock	Chief of Cardiothoracic Surgery	Feb 10, 1956	49
Lt. Tanisha 'Tee' Rollins	FDNY EMS Lieutenant	Aug 16, 1976	29
Lonnie Mayfield (new)	Patient: rebar impalement	Feb 3, 1967	38
Dr. Abraham Lowery	Attending Breast and General Surgeon	Jan 9, 1947	58
Dr. Leland Graves	Chief of Neurosurgery	Apr 18, 1953	52
Patrice Dunmore (new)	Patient: placenta percreta	May 8, 1969	36
Rev. Gerald Dunmore (new)	Patrice's husband	Mar 3, 1965	40
Nurse Gloria Pettiford	Head ER Nurse	Apr 14, 1952	53
Alphonse Broussard (new)	Patient: ESRD, Katrina evacuee	Jan 22, 1928	77
Dr. Nadine Colbert (new)	Nephrology Fellow	Feb 14, 1972	33
Otis Mayfield (new)	Patient: epidural hematoma	Jul 19, 1964	41
Charmaine Mayfield (new)	Otis's wife; Lonnie's ex-wife	Dec 1, 1968	36
Dorian Batiste	Former patient; Katrina evacuee	Feb 15, 1997	8
Rochelle Batiste	Dorian's aunt	Aug 8, 1966	39

Character	Role in this episode	Born	Age
Raymond 'Big Ray' Toles	Chief of Security	Jan 1, 1960	45
Hattie 'Miss Hattie' Lomax	Head Cook, Cafeteria	Mar 3, 1945	60
Corinne Smilley	Esther's mother (V.O.)	Jul 22, 1948	57
Gwendolyn Monroe (new)	Alicia's mother (V.O.)	Oct 10, 1951	53
Curtis Lemieux	Heart transplant patient	Apr 9, 1961	44

Also appearing: FDNY paramedic Andre Fontaine, foreman Walt Briscoe, a scrub tech, a renal-unit lab tech, a psychiatry consult resident, a Red Cross volunteer, Katrina evacuees, NICU nurses, Baby Joshua Dunmore, Beignet the dog, a ceremony reader (V.O.) and the crowd at the Church Street fence. Mentioned: Malcolm Sloan, Naomi Smilley-Crawford, Celestine Broussard, Odette Broussard, Alicia Monroe and Dr. Loretta Wise.

Black don't crack (C-018): every regular reads several years younger than their age on screen. The ages above are exact and binding.

COLD OPEN

1 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL FLOOR - CORRIDOR OUTSIDE L&D - NIGHT
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 7:02 PM

The same second. Clayton's words still hang in the air: "And you must be the man who's been sleeping with my wife."

MARC (26) stands with one hand still holding Esther's. Slowly, very carefully, he lets go. ESTHER (25) doesn't move. DR. CLAYTON HARTWELL (34) stands in the prep-room doorway, a surgical cap half tied, perfectly calm. Down the hall, NATASHA (47) has one hand flat against the wall.

MARC
(very quiet, to Clayton)
Your wife.

CLAYTON
(pleasantly)
Oak Bluffs. August twenty-first, 2004. Ocean Park gazebo. Two hundred guests. (beat) She wore her mother's veil.

Marc turns his head and looks at Esther.

MARC
Es?

ESTHER
(barely)
Marc. I tried to... All day, I tried to...

MARC
(still quiet)
Is it true?

A long beat. Esther can't make the word come out. She nods once.

Marc nods back, slowly, like a man receiving a diagnosis. He doesn't raise his voice. His hands hang open at his sides. That is somehow more frightening than if he'd shouted.

MARC
(to nobody, almost conversational)
A doctor told me last month that my quietest place is the middle of a fight. (beat) I'm very quiet right now.

CLAYTON
(an eyebrow up)
Is that a threat, Dr....?

MARC
(turning to him, perfectly courteous)
No, sir. It's a warning. For me. (beat) You have twins to laser in twenty-eight minutes. I'd hate for you to be late on your first day.

He turns and walks away down the corridor. Toward Natasha. She steps into his path.

NATASHA
(low)
Dr. Bullock. My office.

MARC
(stopping, not looking at her)
With respect, Chief. No.

He walks around her. The stairwell door bangs shut behind him. Natasha stands there with her hand still raised. She lowers it.

Clayton watches the stairwell door. Then he looks at Natasha. Then back at the door. A man who grew up in rooms full of secrets, doing math.

CLAYTON
(to Esther, quietly)
Who is he, Es?

ESTHER
(finally finding her voice, shaking)
Not yours.

MARC (V.O.)
Nobody tells you about the morning after.

2 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - STAIRWELL B - CONTINUOUS
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 7:03 PM

Marc comes down the stairs fast, one flight, two. Then he stops on the landing. He puts both palms flat against the cinderblock wall and breathes. In. Out. In. Out. The way Dr. Wise showed him.

His hands are shaking now that nobody can see.

MARC (V.O.)
They teach you the operation. The incision, the repair, the closure. Nobody teaches you what comes after the closure.

He takes his hands off the wall. Looks at them. Two millimeters of tremor. Then less. Then none.

MARC (V.O.)
What you do when you wake up the next day and the thing you were afraid of is just... true.

He keeps walking down. Not up to the roof. Down. Out.

END OF COLD OPEN

ACT ONE

3 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - FETOSCOPY SUITE - NIGHT
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 7:41 PM

A darkened procedure room. Yolanda Price (31), sedated with a spinal, on the table. Her husband Darnell (33), gowned, holds her hand at her head. An ultrasound screen glows. On another monitor: the fetoscope's view, an underwater world of red and amber, vessels running across the surface of a placenta like rivers on a map.

Clayton operates, a 2-millimeter scope through a tiny trocar in Yolanda's belly. Natasha stands across from him, gowned, assisting. Esther is not in the room.

CLAYTON
(calm, narrating for Yolanda)
Mrs. Price, I'm looking at your placenta right now. It's beautiful. There's your son's cord. There's your daughter's. And right here... (he steers the scope) ...is a vessel that runs from her side to his. That's one of the bad roads.

YOLANDA
(groggy)
Close it.

CLAYTON
Closing it. (beat) Laser.

A flash of green on the screen. The vessel blanches and seals.

CLAYTON
One.

He moves along the vascular equator, methodical, unhurried. Natasha watches the ultrasound, calling out the fetal heart rates.

NATASHA
Recipient one-forty-eight. Donor one-thirty-six.

CLAYTON
Two. (beat) Three.

A quiet minute of green flashes. Darnell watches the screen with his mouth open, a firefighter who's never seen anything like it.

CLAYTON
(not looking up, pleasantly)
Your intern wasn't on the schedule, Chief.

NATASHA
(eyes on the ultrasound)
My intern has been reassigned. Policy 4.12. No staff member supervises a spouse.

CLAYTON
(beat)
You read the form she didn't turn in.

NATASHA
(beat)
I read your face in my office, Dr. Hartwell. (beat) Laser.

CLAYTON
Four.

Green flash. Then, in the same tone, as if discussing the weather:

CLAYTON
The tall one. The intern. (beat) He has your hands.

Natasha doesn't look up. Not a flicker.

NATASHA
Recipient one-fifty. Donor one-thirty-eight. (beat) You have eleven more vessels to find, Doctor. I suggest you look for those.

Clayton smiles behind his mask. He keeps working.

CLAYTON
Five.

4 EXT. EAST RIVER - GANTRY PLAZA STATE PARK - PIER - NIGHT
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 7:58 PM

The Pepsi-Cola sign glows red over the water. Manhattan blazes across the river. Couples, a man fishing, a kid on a scooter. Marc sits at the very end of the pier in his scrubs, his legs over the edge, staring at the U.N.

Footsteps. Harmony (26), out of breath, her white coat over her arm. She sits down next to him without asking. A long silence.

MARC
(not looking at her)
How did you know where I was?

HARMONY
You come here when you can't go to the roof. (beat) And the roof's taken tonight. She said it to the river from up there. (she gestures at the water) So.

Another silence. A ferry slides past, lit up like a birthday cake.

HARMONY
(quietly)
I knew.

Marc turns to look at her for the first time.

HARMONY
Since five o'clock. She told me in the stairwell. She was trying to find you. (beat) I told her to go find you before the cab did. (beat) I'm sorry, Marc. I should have found you myself. I should have run. I didn't run.

MARC
(beat)
Why not?

Harmony opens her mouth. The true answer is right there. She closes it again.

HARMONY
(carefully)
Because it was hers to tell. (beat) And because I thought she'd get there in time.

Marc looks back out at the water.

MARC
Two hours, Harmony.

HARMONY
I know.

MARC
(beat)
No. I mean she had two hours, and you had two hours, and she had ten nights before that. (beat, quieter) And I had a whole summer of telling her I'd tell her "later." (beat) Everybody had time. Nobody used it.

Harmony puts her hand on his back. Just rests it there.

HARMONY
Come home. (beat) Raven's making the gumbo she makes when somebody dies. I told her nobody died. She's making it anyway.

MARC
(almost a laugh)
Nobody died.

HARMONY
(gently)
Something did.

Marc sits with that for a long moment. Then he stands up and holds out his hand. She takes it.

5 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - INTERNS' LOCKER ROOM - NIGHT
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 8:11 PM

Esther sits on the bench in front of her open locker, still in scrubs, staring at nothing. The door opens. Arianna (25), coming off shift, sees her and stops.

ARIANNA
(flat)
Oh. It's you.

She goes to her own locker. Opens it. Starts changing. Esther doesn't move.

ESTHER
(not looking up)
Everybody knows.

ARIANNA
Big Ray stood in front of the L&D hallway for an hour. Kendra's texted me nine times. The blog's going to have it by midnight. (beat) Yeah. Everybody knows.

ESTHER
(beat)
You hate me.

ARIANNA
(pulling on a T-shirt)
I hated you in July. I got over it. (beat) Now I'm just... (she shuts her locker hard) You had ten nights, Smilley.

ESTHER
I know.

ARIANNA
Ten nights on that boat. He told you something that could've gotten him hurt. Something nobody's supposed to know. And you let him. And you sat there with a husband in your pocket.

Esther looks up sharply.

ESTHER
(quiet)
You know what he told me.

ARIANNA
(beat)
I know a lot of things I'm not supposed to know this year. (beat) Here's one more: he would've forgiven you if you'd told him on the first night. He'd have been hurt and he'd have forgiven you, because that's the kind of idiot he is. (beat) You made it so he found out from the husband. In a hallway. In front of his... (she catches herself) ...in front of the Chief.

Esther flinches. Arianna slings her bag over her shoulder. At the door, she stops.

ARIANNA
(not turning around)
For what it's worth. I grew up in a house full of lies. Most people who lie aren't bad. They're scared. (beat) That's not an excuse. It's just a fact.

She goes. Esther sits alone. She reaches into her locker and takes out a small rectangular object: a MiniDV tape in a plastic case. On the label, in her handwriting: "FOR MARC."

6 INT. ELXA AND RUSSELL'S HOUSE - ST. ALBANS - KITCHEN - NIGHT
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 9:47 PM

Elxa (28) sits at the kitchen table with her feet up on a second chair, a plate of oxtails in front of her that she hasn't touched. RUSSELL JEFFRIES (30) stands at the stove, frozen, a serving spoon in his hand.

RUSSELL
(slowly)
Her husband.

ELXA
Her husband.

RUSSELL
(beat)
And your mother hired him.

ELXA
(rubbing her eyes)
My mother hired him. On a three-year contract. With a fetal surgery program named after him in the budget.

RUSSELL
(putting down the spoon)
Does your mother know that she...

ELXA
She found out at six-oh-four tonight. From him. In her office. (beat) Big Ray told Bernie, Bernie told Mama, and Mama walked down that hallway thirty seconds too late.

Russell sits down across from her.

RUSSELL
How's Marc?

ELXA
(beat)
Quiet. (beat) Russell, he was so quiet. He told the man he had twenty-eight minutes until his laser. He was polite. (beat) I've seen my brother crash out. I've never seen him go quiet like that. I don't know which one scares me more.

RUSSELL
(gently)
Maybe quiet's what Dr. Wise was teaching him.

ELXA
(beat)
Maybe. (beat) Or maybe quiet is just loud with the door closed.

Russell pushes the plate of oxtails an inch closer to her. She looks at it. Picks up a fork.

ELXA
(eating, muffled)
These are really good.

RUSSELL
I know. Your daddy's recipe. (beat) Eat. The baby's had a long day too.

7 INT. MONTY'S ON JACKSON - BAR - NIGHT
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 10:24 PM

A quiet Thursday after a loud Wednesday. Monty (42) polishes glasses. The door opens: Clayton, in his navy blazer, his weekender over his shoulder, looking like he's walked into a place he doesn't usually go and is pleasantly surprised by it. He sits at the bar.

CLAYTON
Macallan, if you have it. Neat.

MONTY
(reaching for the top shelf)
I have it. Nobody's asked for it since 2001. (pouring) You're new.

CLAYTON
First night in New York. (lifting the glass) I just put a laser through a placenta and saved two babies. I'd like one drink before I go to a hotel with very bad art.

MONTY
(impressed despite himself)
Congratulations, Doc. On the house.

CLAYTON
(smiling)
Thank you. (beat, casually) I'm told this is where the Queens Grace interns drink.

MONTY
(polishing a glass, carefully)
Some of them.

CLAYTON
There's a tall one. Six-five, maybe. Dimples. Answers to "Bullock."

Monty's polishing doesn't change rhythm by a hair.

MONTY
(pleasantly)
Bullock's a common name.

CLAYTON
(amused)
So I keep hearing.

MONTY
(setting the glass down)
What do you want with him, Doc?

CLAYTON
(beat, looking into his scotch)
I want to know what my wife sees in him. (beat) I'd like to be able to hate him. I've been here four hours and I'm finding it unexpectedly difficult.

Monty studies him. Then he pours a second finger of Macallan into Clayton's glass, unasked.

MONTY
(quiet)
That one's not on the house. (beat) That one's so you understand something. (beat) That kid's been sitting at the end of this bar since July, and I've seen him at his worst. His worst is better than most men's best. (beat) If you came here to find something to hate, Doc, you came to the wrong bar.

Clayton raises the glass to Monty. A real salute.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Noted.

8 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 8, 2005 - 11:52 PM

The porch light. The smell of gumbo through the screen door. Marc sits on the stoop in a sweatshirt with an untouched bowl beside him. Inside, through the window, Harmony and Raven pretend not to watch.

A yellow cab pulls up. Esther gets out. She stands at the bottom of the steps. She doesn't come up.

ESTHER
(quietly)
I'm not going to ask to come in.

MARC
(not looking at her)
Good.

ESTHER
I'm not going to explain tonight, either. You wouldn't hear it, and I'd say it wrong. (beat) I've said everything wrong for two months.

She holds up the MiniDV tape.

ESTHER
I made this in August. The night before Kingston's landing. On my boat. (beat) I recorded about forty seconds and stopped. I didn't have the nerve. (beat) I'm not giving it to you because it explains anything. It doesn't. I'm giving it to you so you know I tried. Before the hallway. Before the roof. (beat) That's all it proves. That I tried and I was a coward.

She sets the tape on the bottom step. She doesn't come any closer.

ESTHER
(beat, her voice cracking)
You told me sober, Marc. And I let you. (beat) I'm so sorry.

She turns and gets back in the cab. It pulls away down 49th Avenue.

Marc sits for a long time. Then he walks down the steps and picks up the tape. "FOR MARC," in her handwriting. He holds it in his palm like something that might go off.

Behind the screen door, Raven has her hand over her mouth. Harmony has already turned away from the window.

END OF ACT ONE

ACT TWO

9 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - LIVING ROOM - MORNING
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 4:58 AM

Gray pre-dawn light. Marc hasn't slept. He sits on the fantastic couch with a borrowed Sony Handycam plugged into the TV, the "FOR MARC" tape inside. His thumb rests on PLAY. He presses it.

On the TV: Esther, in the small cabin of the Clarence, lit by a galley lamp. August. Before everything.

ESTHER (ON TAPE)
Marc. (beat) If you're watching this, it means I didn't have the nerve to tell you myself. There's something you need to know about me. About Boston. About why I...

On the screen she stops. Looks at the red light. Reaches toward the camera. The image jerks and goes to blue.

That's it. Forty-one seconds. Marc stares at the blue screen.

He rewinds. Plays it again. "There's something you need to know about me." Blue.

He rewinds. His thumb hovers. Then he ejects the tape and holds it.

MARC (V.O.)
Forty-one seconds. (beat) She got forty-one seconds closer than I thought she did.

Behind him, on the stairs: Raven, in a bonnet, holding two mugs of coffee. She comes down and hands him one. She glances at the blue screen.

RAVEN
(softly)
That's all there is?

MARC
That's all there is.

RAVEN
(sitting on the arm of the couch)
My grandma used to say a coward is just a brave person who hasn't finished yet. (beat) I used to think it was the dumbest thing anybody ever said.

MARC
And now?

RAVEN
(beat)
Now I think it's the second dumbest. (beat) I'm still mad at her for you, though. Don't take that away from me. I worked hard on it.

Marc almost smiles. He drinks the coffee.

10 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - THE BOARD - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:00 AM

The interns gather at the Board. The air is thick. Esther stands at one end, Marc at the other. Six feet of linoleum between them feels like a mile. Amond (26) stands between them, looking from one to the other like a man at a tennis match he didn't buy a ticket for.

ELXA (28), eighteen weeks pregnant, sweeps in with charts and a ginger ale and looks at absolutely nobody.

ELXA
Assignments. They come from the Chief this morning, not from me, so any complaints go to the twelfth floor. (beat) Smilley: Graves. Construction accident coming in. Two ironworkers.

ESTHER
(quiet)
Yes.

ELXA
Bullock: my trauma service, same accident, the other brother. (beat) Divine: Dr. Hartwell. OB. A placenta accreta, C-hysterectomy at ten, with the Chief.

Harmony freezes. Marc doesn't react. Esther closes her eyes.

HARMONY
(carefully)
Me? With... Dr. Hartwell?

ELXA
(not looking up)
You. The Chief thought it should be someone with a strong stomach and a big heart. (beat) Ellison, Cummings: Gloria's pit. The Katrina evacuees start landing at JFK at nine. We're taking forty-one of them today. (beat) Baker: Dr. Bullock, Senior wants you in his office at six-fifteen. Not the OR. His office.

AMOND
(stiffening)
Why?

ELXA
(finally looking at him)
He said you'd know why. (beat) Go.

They scatter. Elxa catches Marc's sleeve as he passes. Very low.

ELXA
(low)
You okay?

MARC
(low)
I'm at work.

ELXA
(beat)
That's not what I asked.

MARC
(beat)
It's the answer I've got today, Dr. Bullock.

He goes. Elxa watches him. Then she looks across the room at Esther, who's watching him too.

11 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:12 AM

Natasha behind her desk. Esther stands in front of it. Bernie has closed the door very softly and is not listening very hard on the other side of it.

On the desk: Esther's Policy 4.12 form, the one she didn't turn in. Natasha slides it across.

NATASHA
Fill it out. Now. In front of me.

Esther picks up the pen. Under "Marital status of each party," she checks MARRIED. Her hand is steady. Natasha watches.

NATASHA
(beat)
Did you know he was coming?

ESTHER
I knew he was landing at JFK. I didn't know you'd hired him. (beat) I found out his name from you. In Room 3. At four-fifty-two.

NATASHA
(cold)
You let my son walk into that hallway blind.

ESTHER
(meeting her eyes)
Yes. (beat) And you hired my husband, Dr. Donohue.

A long, dangerous silence. Bernie, outside, physically leans away from the door.

NATASHA
(very evenly)
I hired the best fetal surgeon in the country. I didn't know he was anyone's husband.

ESTHER
(beat)
And I didn't know I'd fall in love with the Chief's son. (beat) I came to New York to disappear, Dr. Donohue. I bought a boat because nobody can find a boat. And on the first night I met a man at a bar who didn't tell me who he was either. (beat) We both lied. He told the truth first. I didn't. That's mine. I'll carry it. (beat) But you don't get to look at me like I'm the only one in this building with a secret.

Natasha looks at this twenty-five-year-old intern for a long moment. Something like respect, unwelcome, crosses her face.

NATASHA
(taking the form)
Dr. Hartwell will not supervise you. You will not be on his service. You will not be on Dr. Bullock's service. (beat) And you'll decide what you're going to do about your marriage on your own time, not mine.

ESTHER
(beat)
Yes, ma'am.

NATASHA
(as Esther reaches the door)
Dr. Smilley. (beat) Is he a good man? Hartwell?

ESTHER
(beat, at the door)
He's a brilliant man, Dr. Donohue. (beat) That's not the same question. I used to think it was.

12 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIOTHORACIC CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:15 AM

Robert's office: framed photos of Howard University, a print of Charles Drew, a model of a human heart. Robert

(49) stands with his jacket on. Amond comes in.

ROBERT
Good morning, Dr. Baker. (picking up his keys) Walk with me.

AMOND
Where are we going?

ROBERT
Fourth floor. Dr. Lowery's clinic. He opens at seven. He's opening at six-thirty for you. (beat) I told you tomorrow. It's tomorrow.

AMOND
(beat)
Sir, I have post-ops on Lemieux...

ROBERT
Lemieux has a nineteen-year-old's heart and a nurse named Pauline Greer who would die before she'd let anything happen to it. (holding the door) Walk with me, Dr. Baker. Or I call my wife.

Amond walks.

13 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - TRAUMA 1 AND 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:34 AM

The doors burst open. Tee Rollins (29) and Andre Fontaine with two stretchers. Behind them, a third man, in a hard hat and a reflective vest, running.

TEE
Scaffold collapse, Center Boulevard, the new tower going up by the water. Twenty-two feet. (beat) First: Lonnie Mayfield, thirty-eight, ironworker. A piece of rebar through the left thigh and into the lower abdomen. We cut it at the scaffold. It's still in him. Pressure's ninety-five over sixty and holding. (beat) Second: Otis Mayfield, forty-one, his brother. Fell the full twenty-two feet. Hard hat came off. GCS dropped from fourteen to eleven in the bus. Blown left pupil starting.

Elxa and Marc take Lonnie in Trauma 1. Graves and Esther take Otis in Trauma 2. The foreman, WALT BRISCOE (55), hovers between the curtains.

LONNIE MAYFIELD (38), huge, sweating, a three-foot length of rebar sticking out of his thigh, is weirdly calm. He grabs Marc's wrist.

LONNIE
(through his teeth)
Is Otis alive?

MARC
He's alive. He's right next door. Dr. Graves is with him.

LONNIE
(beat)
Good. (beat) Because I want to kill him myself.

Marc and Elxa exchange a look.

ELXA
(checking the wound, not touching the rebar)
Nobody pull this. Nobody touch it. It's plugging whatever it went through. Type and cross eight units. CT if he holds his pressure; OR if he doesn't. (to Lonnie) Mr. Mayfield, why do you want to kill your brother?

LONNIE
(grimacing)
He married my wife.

MARC
(beat)
Recently?

LONNIE
Nineteen ninety-seven. (beat) We haven't spoken in eight years. Then the union sends both of us to the same tower. Same crew. Same scaffold. (beat) We were arguing about her when the planks gave.

Through the curtain, Graves's voice: "Left pupil's blown. He's herniating. Get him to CT, then straight to OR Six. Smilley, call it in." Esther's voice: "Calling it."

Lonnie hears his brother's name and closes his eyes.

LONNIE
(quiet)
He was standing on my side. When it went. (beat) He pushed me toward the beam.

14 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - DR. LOWERY'S CLINIC - EXAM ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:48 AM

Amond lies on an exam table in his scrubs. Dr. Abraham Lowery (58) presses on his right lower abdomen with two fingers. Amond's jaw clenches. Robert stands by the window with his arms crossed.

LOWERY
(pressing)
There. Not McBurney's point. Lower, and more medial. (beat) How long?

AMOND
(stiff)
Three weeks. Off and on.

LOWERY
Blood in your stool?

AMOND
(beat)
Once. Last week. (Robert turns from the window.) Dark. Once.

LOWERY
(straightening up)
Your ultrasound in Forest Hills said "no appendicitis." Fine. It wouldn't see what I'm thinking. (to Robert) I want a CT, and then a Meckel's scan. Technetium. This morning.

AMOND
(sitting up)
A Meckel's? I'm twenty-six.

LOWERY
(dry)
And I'm fifty-eight, and I've taken out Meckel's diverticula in a nine-year-old and a sixty-year-old. The rule of twos isn't a law, son. It's a suggestion. (beat) Two percent of people. Two inches long. Two feet from the ileocecal valve. Symptoms usually by age two. Except when they wait.

Amond looks at Robert.

ROBERT
(quietly)
You heard him.

15 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 6 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:22 AM

Otis Mayfield on the table, his head shaved on the left, a large flap of skull already lifted. Graves at the field. Esther across from him. A massive dark clot sits under the bone.

GRAVES
Acute epidural. Classic. Middle meningeal artery torn by the fracture. (beat) Suction, Dr. Smilley.

Esther suctions. Steady. Graves glances at her hands.

GRAVES
(working)
You know what I like about epidurals? (beat) They're honest. The blood's on the outside of the brain. Get it out fast enough, and the brain underneath never knew how close it came.

ESTHER
(beat)
And subdurals?

GRAVES
Subdurals are liars. The bleeding's underneath, slow, quiet. By the time anybody notices, the damage is done. (beat) Bipolar. (he coagulates the artery) There. The leak is closed.

A long beat. They work.

GRAVES
(not looking up)
I was on the floor last night at seven-oh-two, Dr. Smilley. I heard what I heard.

Esther's hands don't stop. But her eyes come up.

GRAVES
(still working)
I'm not going to say anything about it. It's not my business. (beat) But I'll tell you what I tell every intern who thinks they can hold a secret in a hospital. (beat) A hospital is a building full of people who look under the skin for a living. Nothing stays subdural here for long.

ESTHER
(quiet)
Yes, sir.

GRAVES
(beat)
Your hands are steady, though. (beat) Irrigate. Let's put his bone back.

16 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - PRE-OP BAY - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:21 AM

Patrice Dunmore (36), thirty-four weeks pregnant with her fifth child, sits on a gurney in a gown, gripping the hand of her husband, REV. GERALD DUNMORE (40), pastor of a storefront church in South Ozone Park. Harmony holds the consent form. Clayton sits on a stool so he's lower than the patient, not standing over her.

CLAYTON
Mrs. Dunmore. Four C-sections. Your placenta grew into the scar from the last one, and probably through it. (beat) Today we deliver your son first. Then, most likely, we take your uterus, because the placenta won't come off it without bleeding we can't stop.

PATRICE
(beat)
No more babies.

CLAYTON
(gently)
No more babies. (beat) I know that's a lot to hear at nine in the morning.

PATRICE
(laughing through tears)
Doctor, I've got four boys under ten and a fifth one kicking my ribs. (beat) I'm not crying because I'm sad. I'm crying because I'm scared to bleed.

CLAYTON
(taking her hand)
Then let me be the one who's scared about that. That's my job today. Yours is to meet your son.

Harmony watches him. This isn't the man from the hallway. Or it is, and that's worse.

GERALD
(to Clayton)
Can I pray before you go in?

CLAYTON
(standing, bowing his head without hesitation)
I was hoping you'd ask, Reverend.

Gerald prays. Clayton's head stays bowed. Harmony bows hers too. Then she looks up, and Clayton is looking at her across the gurney.

CLAYTON
(low, as they walk out)
You don't like me, Dr. Divine.

HARMONY
(beat)
I don't know you, Dr. Hartwell.

CLAYTON
(beat)
That's fair. (beat) Most people who do know me don't like me either. Until about the third week.

17 INT. PELL PAVILION - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:40 AM

A white MTA charter bus, borrowed from the airport run, pulls into the ambulance bay. "QUEENS GRACE - KATRINA INTAKE" is taped to its windshield on a piece of cardboard. Gloria (53), with a clipboard, organizes a line of wheelchairs like a general. Raven and Arianna stand beside her in gowns and masks. A Red Cross VOLUNTEER steps off the bus.

RED CROSS VOLUNTEER
Forty-one from the Astrodome, flown into JFK this morning. Eleven dialysis, six insulin-dependent, three oxygen, four pregnant, two psychiatric, one hospice. (beat) The rest just need everything.

The evacuees step off one at a time, blinking at Queens: old women in donated sweatsuits, a teenager carrying a toddler, a man in a Saints jersey holding a plastic bag with everything he owns.

The last man off the bus moves slowly, with a cane. MR. ALPHONSE BROUSSARD (77), dignified in a pressed white shirt someone gave him in Houston, a fedora on his head, a

Purple Heart pinned to the pocket. He's gray, puffy-faced and breathing hard. A fistula bulges on his left forearm: a dialysis patient.

Raven goes to him.

RAVEN
Sir, I'm Dr. Ellison. When was your last dialysis?

BROUSSARD
(courteous, winded)
Good morning, young lady. (beat) August twenty-seventh. Saturday. At the dialysis center on Elysian Fields. (beat) It's been closed since. On account of the water.

Raven goes pale. Arianna, beside her, does the math out loud.

ARIANNA
(low)
That's thirteen days without dialysis.

BROUSSARD
They gave me some in the Astrodome. Once. (beat) And there was a fellow in Houston who gave me something to drink that tasted like sand.

ARIANNA
(to Gloria)
Kayexalate. (to Raven) He needs a potassium and an EKG right now.

Raven is already helping Broussard into a wheelchair. He takes off his fedora as he sits, out of habit.

BROUSSARD
(to Raven)
My wife, Odette, used to say they'd have to carry me out of New Orleans. (beat) I suppose they did.

18 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - BAY 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 9:58 AM

Broussard on a monitor, an EKG running. The tracing shows tall, peaked, tented T waves and a widening QRS. Arianna

stares at it.

ARIANNA
Peaked Ts. Wide QRS. (to Gloria) Calcium gluconate, one gram, push now. Ten units insulin, one amp of D50. Albuterol neb. (beat) And call renal for emergent hemodialysis.

The LAB TECH hands Raven a slip.

RAVEN
(reading)
Potassium seven point nine.

GLORIA
(pushing the calcium)
Lord. That man walked off a bus with a seven-nine.

Broussard, under the oxygen mask, holds up one hand weakly.

BROUSSARD
Doctors. (beat) A moment, please.

They pause. He looks at them with very clear eyes.

BROUSSARD
(calm)
I'm seventy-seven years old. I was born on North Robertson Street in 1928. I came back from Korea with a Purple Heart and married Odette Delacroix at St. Augustine Church in 1953. (beat) Odette's buried in St. Louis Cemetery Number Two, and on Tuesday they told me the water was up to the tombs. (beat) I've been on that machine three days a week for six years. (beat) I've decided I'm finished, young ladies. I'd like you to let me go.

Silence in the bay. Raven's face crumples.

RAVEN
(immediately)
No. No, sir. You're dehydrated and toxic, and your potassium is seven-nine, and nobody thinks straight with a potassium of seven-nine...

ARIANNA
(quietly)
Ellison.

RAVEN
(turning on her)
What?

ARIANNA
(beat, not unkind)
He's thinking pretty straight to me.

Raven stares at her. Broussard closes his eyes behind the mask.

END OF ACT TWO

ACT THREE

19 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - OR 2 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:20 AM

Lonnie Mayfield's belly is open. The rebar still runs through his thigh and up through the pelvis into the abdomen. Elxa on one side, Marc on the other, and Robert, called in for the pelvic vessels, at the head of the field.

ROBERT
The bar's passed between the external iliac artery and vein. Missed both by millimeters. (beat) Dr. Bullock, Junior. Control above and below before anybody touches that bar.

MARC
(working, perfectly calm)
Vessel loops above and below.

His hands are steady. Elxa watches them. So does Robert. Neither says anything.

ELXA
Small bowel's got two holes. Sigmoid's clean. (beat) Okay. Pull the bar.

A SCRUB TECH, braced, pulls the rebar out from below, slowly, inch by inch. Everyone watches the iliac vessels. Nothing bleeds.

ROBERT
(exhaling)
Out.

MARC
(quietly)
He fell twenty-two feet and a piece of steel threaded the needle between his artery and his vein.

ROBERT
(beat)
Sometimes the body is luckier than the man.

They start repairing the bowel. A long, quiet beat. Then:

ROBERT
(not looking up)
Your mother told me.

MARC
(not looking up)
I figured.

ROBERT
(beat)
I married a woman with a secret once, son. The biggest secret in American medicine. (beat) She told me on our second date. In a diner on Georgia Avenue.

MARC
I know the story, Dad.

ROBERT
(beat)
You don't know the end of it. (beat) I didn't talk to her for three weeks after that diner. Not because of who her father was. Because she'd let me talk about my daddy's bus route for an hour before she told me. (beat) I felt like a fool. I felt like everybody knew but me.

Marc's hands pause. Then keep moving.

MARC
(quiet)
What made you call her?

ROBERT
(beat)
I didn't. She showed up at Founders Library and sat down across from me and said, "I'm not going to apologize for my father. I'm going to apologize for waiting." (beat) That was the difference. (beat) Two-oh silk, please.

Elxa, across the table, keeps her eyes on the bowel. Her eyes are smiling over her mask.

20 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - LABOR AND DELIVERY - OR 1 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:30 AM

PATRICE DUNMORE (36), a choir director and mother of four, under general anesthesia, her belly open, a baby already delivered: a boy, wailing, thirty-four weeks, handed off to the NICU team. Now the hard part. Clayton and Natasha operate on the uterus. The placenta has grown into the wall, through it, and into the back of the bladder. Harmony holds a retractor and tries not to faint.

CLAYTON
Percreta. It's into the bladder serosa. (beat) Chief, your 1996 paper said leave the placenta in place and take the whole uterus with it. Don't try to separate it.

NATASHA
(working)
I wrote it. I'm aware.

CLAYTON
(smiling under his mask)
I quote it to my fellows. (beat) Uterine arteries.

They work in silent rhythm, two surgeons who have done this before. Harmony, against her will, is mesmerized.

CLAYTON
(to Harmony, without looking)
Dr. Divine. You're holding that retractor like it owes you money. Relax your wrist. You'll last longer.

HARMONY
(relaxing her wrist)
Yes, Dr. Hartwell.

CLAYTON
(beat)
Do you live with him? Bullock?

Harmony's retractor slips a quarter inch. Natasha's eyes snap up.

NATASHA
(ice)
Dr. Hartwell.

CLAYTON
(pleasantly)
Small talk, Chief. (beat) Dr. Divine?

HARMONY
(beat, steadying the retractor, steadier than she feels)
I live with him, Dr. Hartwell. (beat) He's the best man I've ever known. (beat) And I'm holding a retractor next to a bladder, so I'm not going to say anything else.

A beat. Clayton glances up at her. Something in his face shifts: respect, and a flicker of something worse. He looks back down.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
Then I'm in more trouble than I thought. (beat) Clamp.

21 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - DR. LOWERY'S CLINIC - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:46 AM

Lowery puts two images up on the light box: a CT, and a nuclear-medicine scan with a bright spot glowing in the right lower abdomen. Amond stares at them. Robert stands behind him.

LOWERY
Meckel's diverticulum. About four centimeters. Inflamed. Your Meckel's scan lights up, which means ectopic gastric mucosa: stomach lining, in your small intestine, making acid where acid's got no business being. (beat) That's your pain. That's your dark stool. It's ulcerating the bowel next to it.

AMOND
(staring at the scan)
Resection.

LOWERY
Laparoscopic. Forty-five minutes. Home in two days, back to work in two weeks. (beat) I'd like to do it Monday.

AMOND
(immediately)
Not Monday.

LOWERY
(dry)
I wasn't asking your schedule, Dr. Baker. I was telling you mine.

AMOND
(turning to Robert)
Lemieux's first biopsy is Wednesday. I want to be at that biopsy. And the Mayfield vascular follow-up, and... (beat) Two weeks off, in my first year, on the transplant service. They'll give my spot to Kennerly.

ROBERT
(quietly)
Kennerly is suspended.

AMOND
Then to somebody worse.

Lowery looks at Robert. Robert looks at Amond for a long, long moment.

ROBERT
(finally)
When?

AMOND
(beat)
October. After Lemieux's six-week biopsy. October fourteenth. (beat) It's a Friday. Two weeks takes me to Halloween.

LOWERY
(shaking his head)
Meckel's that bleed, bleed more. Meckel's that ulcerate, perforate. (beat) If you get a fever, or your stool turns black again, or you so much as faint in the shower, you're on my table that day. Not the fourteenth. That day.

AMOND
(beat)
Yes, sir.

Lowery writes "10/14/05 - LAP MECKEL'S - BAKER, A." on his schedule. He doesn't look happy about it.

ROBERT
(as they leave, low)
I'm writing this down too, Dr. Baker. (beat) If you lie to me about a single drop of blood between now and the fourteenth, I'll take you off my service myself.

22 INT. PELL PAVILION - THE PIT - BAY 4 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 12:05 PM

The calcium, insulin and albuterol have bought time. Broussard's EKG looks less frightening: the T waves are still peaked, but the QRS has narrowed. The renal fellow, DR. NADINE COLBERT (33), waits with a temporary dialysis catheter kit. Broussard still hasn't agreed.

A psychiatry CONSULT RESIDENT closes a clipboard and nods to Arianna: he has capacity. He leaves. Raven stands at the foot of the bed, arms crossed, eyes red. Arianna sits on the edge of the bed.

ARIANNA
Mr. Broussard. The psychiatrist says you understand exactly what you're deciding. (beat) That means it's your decision. Not mine. Not hers.

BROUSSARD
(gently)
Thank you, Doctor.

ARIANNA
(beat)
But I'm going to ask you something anyway, because I'm from Gary, Indiana, and nobody in Gary minds their own business.

BROUSSARD
(a small smile)
Go on.

ARIANNA
Is there anybody alive who's going to want to know where you went?

A long pause. Broussard looks at the ceiling.

BROUSSARD
(beat)
My granddaughter. Celestine. (beat) She's at Dillard, in nursing school. Dillard's under water too. They sent her to Spelman, in Atlanta. (beat) I haven't been able to reach her. The phones...

RAVEN
(stepping forward)
Then let us find her. (beat) Mr. Broussard, please. One dialysis. Just one. Long enough for us to find Celestine and for you to hear her voice. (beat) If you still want to stop after that, I'll... (she can barely say it) ...I'll respect it. I swear I will. But don't let the last person who sees you alive be a stranger from Queens.

Broussard looks at Raven for a long time. Then at Arianna. Then back at Raven.

BROUSSARD
(beat)
You're not a stranger. You're a Southern girl. I could tell by how you said "sir."

RAVEN
(wiping her eyes)
Savannah.

BROUSSARD
(beat)
One. (holding up a finger) One dialysis. (beat) And you find my Celestine.

Dr. Colbert opens the catheter kit before he can change his mind. Arianna catches Raven's eye across the bed. A small nod. Raven nods back.

ARIANNA
(low, as they step out)
That was good. What you said.

RAVEN
(low)
You were good first. (beat) I hated you for it for about a minute.

ARIANNA
(almost smiling)
Only a minute?

RAVEN
(beat)
I'm working on it.

23 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - ON-CALL ROOM 3 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 1:40 PM

Marc comes in, pulling off his surgical cap, and stops. Esther is sitting on the bottom bunk. She stands up.

ESTHER
I asked Kendra which on-call room you use after surgery. (beat) I'll leave if you want me to.

MARC
(beat, closing the door behind him)
No. (beat) Say it. All of it. Sober. In a room. Like you made me.

Esther takes a breath.

ESTHER
His name is Clayton Hartwell. I met him when I was twenty-one, at a Jack and Jill gala in Boston. He was a resident at the Brigham. Eight years older. Brilliant. Funny. Old Milton money. My father ran a hardware store on Blue Hill Avenue. (beat) We got married in Oak Bluffs in August 2004. (beat) In February, I came home early from a shift and found him in our bed. (beat) With Malcolm.

MARC
(beat)
Who's Malcolm?

ESTHER
(her voice breaking)
Malcolm Sloan. He grew up at our kitchen table. My mother fed him when his didn't. He walked me to school. He taught me to drive. He was my brother in every way that counts. (beat) And he was in my bed with my husband.

Marc closes his eyes.

ESTHER
I left that night. I took a train to New York with one suitcase and the ring in my pocket. I changed my number. I bought a boat because nobody can find you on a boat. I never filed. I couldn't even make myself say the word "divorce" out loud. (beat) And then I walked into Monty's the night before my first day and met a man who didn't tell me his last name either.

MARC
(quiet)
You had ten nights.

ESTHER
I know.

MARC
(still quiet)
You made me tell you sober. You made it a choice. And I chose you. (beat) And the whole time, you were holding that ring.

ESTHER
I took it off. The night you told me. I put it in a drawer.

MARC
(beat)
A drawer's not a divorce, Esther.

That lands. She has nothing to say to it.

MARC
(beat)
Do you still love him?

ESTHER
(immediately)
No. (beat) I don't know. (beat) I loved who I thought he was. I don't know who he is. I never let him tell me. I never let him say he's sorry. I just ran. (beat) And now he's here, and he's asking for the one thing I never gave him. A conversation.

MARC
(beat)
Are you going to give it to him?

A long, terrible pause.

ESTHER
(barely)
I think I have to. (beat) I made a vow, Marc. I didn't keep it, and neither did he. But I made it. In front of my mother. (beat) I don't know how to end something I never let finish.

Marc looks at her for a long time. Then he nods.

MARC
(quiet, steady)
Then go finish it. (beat) But you don't get to do it while you're with me. (beat) I'm not going to be the drawer you put me in while you decide.

ESTHER
(crying now)
Marc...

MARC
(opening the door)
I love you, Esther. (beat) That's not a weapon. It's just true. I don't know what to do with it yet. (beat) Please go.

She goes. He closes the door behind her and stands with his forehead against it. He doesn't punch anything. He doesn't yell. He just stands there.

END OF ACT THREE

ACT FOUR

24 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - BED 5 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 2:31 PM

Otis Mayfield (41), his head bandaged, extubated, groggy. Esther checks his pupils with a penlight. Equal. Reactive.

ESTHER
Mr. Mayfield. Can you tell me where you are?

OTIS
(hoarse)
Hospital. (beat) Lonnie. Where's Lonnie?

ESTHER
Your brother's out of surgery. A piece of rebar went through his leg and into his belly. It missed his artery by about two millimeters. He's going to be okay.

Otis closes his eyes. Tears leak out from under the lids.

OTIS
(whispering)
Thank you, Jesus.

ESTHER
(gently)
The foreman said you pushed him. When the scaffold went.

OTIS
(beat)
Toward the beam. I was closer to the edge. (beat) I didn't think about it. I just pushed.

ESTHER
He said you married his wife.

OTIS
(a wet, tired laugh)
He tell you the whole story or just the headline?

ESTHER
(beat)
Just the headline.

OTIS
(beat)
Charmaine left him in '96. He was drinking. Bad. Put his fist through a wall in front of her. (beat) I was the one who drove her to her mother's that night. I was the one who sat with her at the kitchen table for a year after. (beat) I didn't steal my brother's wife, Doc. I just stayed when he didn't. (beat) And he's hated me for it for eight years. (beat) He's been sober six of them. Nobody told him I sit in the back row at his sobriety anniversary every year.

Esther sets down the penlight. She's very still.

ESTHER
(quiet)
Why didn't you ever tell him?

OTIS
(beat)
He never asked me. (beat) And I never made him listen.

25 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - BED 5 - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:18 PM

Marc wheels Lonnie Mayfield, post-op, in a wheelchair with his leg in a dressing and an IV pole attached, into the Neuro ICU. Lonnie insisted. He stops beside his brother's bed.

Otis opens his eyes. The brothers look at each other. A long silence. Esther, at the nurses' station, watches through the glass. Marc doesn't look at her.

LONNIE
(gruff)
You look like hell.

OTIS
You got a pole through your stomach.

LONNIE
(beat)
Through my leg. It just went in my stomach for a visit.

Neither smiles. Then:

LONNIE
(quiet)
You pushed me.

OTIS
(beat)
You were on the wrong side of the plank.

LONNIE
(beat)
You could've gone to the beam yourself.

OTIS
(beat)
Then who'd have pushed you?

Lonnie looks away. His jaw works. When he looks back, his eyes are wet.

LONNIE
(barely)
Charmaine still make that peach cobbler?

OTIS
(beat)
Every Sunday. (beat) There's always a plate left over. (beat) She makes it big on purpose, Lon. Has for eight years. I never asked her why.

Lonnie reaches over from the wheelchair. Otis reaches back. Two big, scarred ironworkers' hands grip each other across the gap between the bed and the chair.

Marc stands behind the wheelchair, looking at the floor.

MARC (V.O.)
Sometimes the morning after is just the night before, with the lights on.

26 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NEURO ICU - FAMILY ALCOVE - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:31 PM

CHARMAINE MAYFIELD (36), in a Duane Reade pharmacist's smock, out of breath from running from the train, stops at the glass when she sees the brothers holding hands. She puts her hand over her mouth. Esther comes up beside her.

ESTHER
(gently)
Mrs. Mayfield? Both of them are going to be fine.

CHARMAINE
(not taking her eyes off the glass)
Eight years. (beat) Eight years I've been waiting for those two fools to touch each other without a fist.

A beat. Esther looks at the brothers. Then at Charmaine.

ESTHER
(quietly, before she can stop herself)
Can I ask you something? (beat) How did you decide? Between them?

Charmaine turns and looks at the young doctor. Really looks.

CHARMAINE
(beat)
I didn't decide between them, baby. (beat) I decided about me. I decided I wasn't going to live scared in my own house. Once I decided that, the rest decided itself. (beat) Lonnie wasn't a bad man. He was a man who hurt me. Those aren't always different men. (beat) And Otis didn't save me. He just showed up every day after I saved myself.

Esther looks at her for a long time.

CHARMAINE
(beat)
Whoever he is, you look like somebody who's been deciding about everybody but you.

She goes into the ICU. Esther stays by the glass.

27 INT. PELL PAVILION - DIALYSIS ALCOVE - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 3:44 PM

Broussard reclines in a dialysis chair, his blood running through the machine in red loops. He looks better: less puffy, more alert. Arianna holds the bay phone to her ear. Raven stands beside her, bouncing on her toes.

ARIANNA
(into the phone)
Yes. Spelman College, Office of the Dean of Students. (beat) Celestine Broussard. A Dillard nursing student, displaced. She would have arrived around the sixth. (beat) Her grandfather is in a hospital in New York and needs to speak to her. It's medical. (beat) I'll hold.

Raven looks at Broussard. He looks back calmly.

BROUSSARD
Child, you're going to wear a hole in that floor.

RAVEN
(bouncing)
I can't help it.

ARIANNA
(into the phone, straightening)
Yes. (beat) Yes, I'll... yes. (she holds the phone out to Broussard) Mr. Broussard. (beat) It's her.

Broussard takes the phone in a hand that is suddenly shaking.

BROUSSARD
(into the phone)
Celestine? (beat) Celestine, baby, it's Grandpère.

A sound comes through the receiver: a young woman sobbing. Broussard closes his eyes.

BROUSSARD
(into the phone)
I'm in New York, baby. Queens. They got me on the machine. (beat) No, I'm fine. I'm fine. A Southern girl and a girl from Indiana won't let me die. (he opens his eyes and looks at Raven) I tried. They won't let me.

Raven laughs and cries at once. Arianna turns away so nobody sees her face.

BROUSSARD
(into the phone, softer)
When do you graduate, baby? (beat) May 2007. (beat) Then I suppose I'd better see that. Your grandmother would never forgive me.

He holds the phone against his chest and looks at Raven.

BROUSSARD
(quietly)
Three days a week, Dr. Ellison. Until May of 2007. (beat) After that, we'll talk again.

RAVEN
(barely)
Yes, sir.

28 EXT. PELL PAVILION - AMBULANCE BAY - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 4:20 PM

Dorian Batiste (8), discharged, a backpack full of insulin pens and a glucose meter from the hospital's new Donohue Bridge Fund pharmacy, stands with his aunt Rochelle (39) by the curb. Arianna comes out to say goodbye.

A white van with "LOUISIANA SPCA - KATRINA RESCUE TRANSPORT" painted on the side pulls into the bay. Big Ray (45) climbs out of the passenger seat, of all people, carrying a wire crate.

Inside the crate, a skinny brown dog with a white star on his chest stands up and starts barking.

DORIAN
(screaming)
BEIGNET!

Big Ray sets down the crate and opens it. The dog hits Dorian like a cannonball. Boy and dog roll on the sidewalk. Rochelle sobs. Arianna laughs.

ARIANNA
(to Big Ray)
How did you end up in a dog van?

BIG RAY
(deadpan)
A foundation called security this morning. Said there was a delivery that needed "personal escort from Teterboro." (beat) I don't ask questions about foundations, Dr. Cummings.

Up on the second floor, through a window, Marc watches. Arianna glances up and sees him. Just a nod between them. He disappears from the window.

29 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - NICU - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 4:41 PM

A tiny boy, four pounds eleven ounces, in an isolette under blue lights, on CPAP. A card taped to the plastic: "BABY BOY DUNMORE - 34 WKS - JOSHUA." Patrice, post-op and pale, sits in a wheelchair beside him with her hand through the porthole. Gerald stands behind her. Harmony checks the chart.

PATRICE
(weak, smiling)
Joshua. (beat) He's going to be my last.

HARMONY
(gently)
He's perfect, Mrs. Dunmore. The NICU says he's breathing on his own by Monday.

PATRICE
(beat)
They told me I lost four units. (beat) Dr. Hartwell told me in recovery. He held my hand. (beat) He said, "Your uterus fought me, Mrs. Dunmore, and I won." (beat) Is he always like that?

Harmony hesitates.

HARMONY
(carefully)
I've known him for a day.

GERALD
(smiling)
The Lord sends who He sends, Dr. Divine. Sometimes He sends them in a nice blazer.

Harmony smiles politely. When she turns away from them, she isn't smiling.

30 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CHIEF'S OFFICE - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:05 PM

Natasha sits at her desk with her shoes off. Robert comes in and sits across from her. He loosens his tie. They are, for one moment, just married people.

NATASHA
I hired him, Robert. (beat) I read thirty-one laser cases and a Leuven fellowship and I didn't read the emergency contact.

ROBERT
You hired the best fetal surgeon in America. He saved two babies last night and a uterus this morning. (beat) You didn't hire a husband. Husbands don't come with CVs.

NATASHA
(beat)
He asked Harmony Divine whether she lives with Marc. In the middle of a percreta.

ROBERT
(beat)
And?

NATASHA
She told him Marc was the best man she'd ever known, and then she told him to let her hold her retractor. (beat) I almost hugged her over the sterile field.

Robert smiles. Then gets serious.

ROBERT
I told him the Founders Library story. Marc. In the OR.

NATASHA
(looking up sharply)
You told him I apologized?

ROBERT
(beat)
I told him you showed up.

Natasha looks at her husband. Something softens in her face. Then it closes up again.

NATASHA
(quiet)
Last night, in the fetoscopy suite, Hartwell said, "The tall one. He has your hands."

ROBERT
(beat)
Then he's the smartest man in this building after Leland Graves.

NATASHA
(beat)
That's what worries me.

31 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - SURGICAL SCRUB ROOM - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 5:38 PM

Marc scrubs alone for a late add-on. The door opens. Clayton comes in, scrub cap on, and goes to the sink beside him. They scrub side by side in silence for a long moment, like two gunfighters at a saloon who've agreed not to draw.

CLAYTON
(finally)
I'm not here to fight you.

MARC
(scrubbing)
Okay.

CLAYTON
I'm here for my marriage. (beat) I made the worst mistake of my life in February. I've been trying to apologize for seven months to a woman who changed her phone number twice. (beat) I'm not going to apologize to you for being her husband.

MARC
(beat)
I didn't ask you to.

Clayton glances at him.

MARC
(still scrubbing, steady)
Fight for it, Dr. Hartwell. Honestly. In the open. (beat) If she picks you, I'll hate it, and I'll live. (beat) If she picks you because you made her feel like she owed you, that's different.

CLAYTON
(beat, half a smile)
That sounds like a threat again.

MARC
(turning off the water)
It's not. (beat) Yesterday I was quiet because I chose to be. (beat) You hurt her once. If you hurt her again, I won't choose quiet.

Marc shakes the water off his hands. Clayton studies him in the mirror over the sinks.

CLAYTON
(pleasantly)
You're the Chief's son.

MARC
(not missing a beat)
Bullock's a common name.

CLAYTON
(smiling)
So everybody in Queens keeps telling me. (beat) I grew up in Milton, Dr. Bullock. My father chaired the board at the Brigham. I know what money sounds like when it's whispering. (beat) This hospital is whispering very loudly around you.

Marc backs through the OR door, his hands held up, dripping.

MARC
(pleasantly)
Then I'd stop listening at doors, Dr. Hartwell. (beat) It's a big building. You'll hear all kinds of things.

The door swings shut. Clayton stands alone at the sink, scrubbing, thinking.

32 EXT. WORLD'S FAIR MARINA - FLUSHING BAY - DOCK - DAY
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 6:47 PM

The golden hour over Flushing Bay. A plane roars into LaGuardia. Esther sits on the cabin roof of the Clarence in a sweatshirt. Footsteps on the dock. She looks up and goes rigid.

Clayton, in his blazer, with a paper bag from a bakery. He stops at the edge of the boat.

ESTHER
(sharp)
How did you find this?

CLAYTON
(beat)
Naomi.

ESTHER
(closing her eyes)
Of course Naomi.

CLAYTON
She said if I came within ten feet of you without asking, she'd drive down from Boston and run me over with her Volvo. (beat) So. (he stays on the dock) May I?

ESTHER
(beat)
No.

CLAYTON
(nodding, setting the bag on the dock)
Rugelach. From the place on Austin Street. You used to like the apricot.

A long silence. The water laps at the hull.

CLAYTON
(quietly)
I'm sorry, Es. (beat) Not "I'm sorry you saw." Not "I'm sorry it happened." (beat) I'm sorry I did it. In our bed. With the one person in the world you trusted more than me. (beat) I've wanted to say that to your face since February eleventh.

Esther flinches at the date. The anniversary of her father's death. He knows it. That's partly why he says it.

ESTHER
(barely)
Don't say his name on my boat.

CLAYTON
(beat)
I won't. (beat) I'm asking for one thing. One month. September. Thirty days. We talk. We see somebody, a counselor, anybody you pick. We have dinner like people who were married once. (beat) And at the end of thirty days, if you still want to be finished, I'll sign whatever your lawyer puts in front of me. No fight. No Boston lawyers. (beat) Thirty days. That's what I'm asking for after thirteen months.

Esther looks out at the water for a long time. Then at the bakery bag. Then at him.

ESTHER
(finally)
I'll think about it.

CLAYTON
(nodding)
That's more than I had yesterday.

He turns and walks back up the dock. Esther watches him go. The bakery bag sits at the edge of the dock where he left it.

END OF ACT FOUR

ACT FIVE

33 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CAFETERIA - NIGHT
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 7:15 PM

The cafeteria at shift change. Miss Hattie Lomax (60) wipes down the steam table. Amond sits alone with a plate of nothing. Arianna slides into the seat across from him with a tray of fried chicken.

ARIANNA
(eating)
Well?

AMOND
(flat)
Meckel's diverticulum. Four centimeters. Ectopic gastric mucosa. Lowery wants to take it out laparoscopically.

ARIANNA
When?

AMOND
(beat)
October fourteenth.

Arianna stops chewing.

ARIANNA
It's September ninth.

AMOND
I'm aware of the date.

ARIANNA
(putting down the chicken)
You've got an ulcerating diverticulum and dark stool, and you scheduled it five weeks out so you don't miss a biopsy.

AMOND
Lemieux's six-week biopsy. And the Mayfield follow-up. And...

ARIANNA
(flat)
You're an idiot, Baker.

AMOND
(beat)
Yes.

A long pause. Arianna picks the chicken back up.

ARIANNA
(eating)
Dr. Bullock knows?

AMOND
He wrote it down. He said if I lie to him about a single drop of blood, he'll take me off his service himself.

ARIANNA
(beat)
Good. (beat) That makes three of us watching you. Me, him and your intestine.

MISS HATTIE
(from behind the steam table, not looking up)
Four. Eat something, Dr. Baker. You look like a ghost in a lab coat.

34 INT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - KITCHEN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 8:52 PM

The kitchen, full. Raven reheats the gumbo. Harmony makes rice. Arianna has brought a twelve-pack of Brooklyn Lager "for the house." Amond has brought, after deep consideration, a single bag of ice. Marc sits at the island, and for the first time in two days, people are crowded around him. Nobody mentions Esther.

RAVEN
(stirring)
Amond. You brought ice.

AMOND
You said "bring something." Ice is something.

ARIANNA
(opening a beer)
He's on a restricted diet. (beat) He's very sensitive.

AMOND
(glaring)
Cummings.

ARIANNA
(innocent)
What? I didn't say anything. I said "sensitive."

HARMONY
(to Marc, setting down a bowl)
Eat.

MARC
(looking around the kitchen at all of them)
Did you all plan this?

RAVEN
(beat)
Plan is a strong word.

HARMONY
Raven made a phone tree.

RAVEN
(defensive)
It's an efficient system!

Marc laughs. A real laugh. The first one in two days. They all hear it. Nobody comments on it. They just keep eating.

AMOND
(after a beat, not looking at Marc)
For the record. (beat) If you'd hit him in that hallway, I'd have helped you hide the body.

MARC
(beat)
You hate blood outside an OR.

AMOND
I'd have worn gloves.

Laughter. Marc looks around the table at them: the gumbo, the beer, the ice, the phone tree.

MARC (V.O.)
They tell you a surgical intern has no family. No time, no sleep, no life outside the hospital.

MARC (V.O.)
They don't tell you that you build one anyway. Out of whoever's left standing at two in the morning.

35 EXT. THE HOUSE ON 49TH AVENUE - STOOP - NIGHT
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 10:41 PM

Everyone has gone home or upstairs. Marc and Harmony sit on the stoop, the 7 train rumbling in the distance. Harmony has her knees pulled up. She holds something in her lap: a small laminated card. A photo of a smiling young woman with box braids. "ALICIA DENISE MONROE. MARCH 8, 1979 - SEPTEMBER 11, 2001."

MARC
(looking at it)
Who's that?

HARMONY
(beat)
Alicia. (beat) We grew up three houses apart in Hollis. Same church, same Girl Scout troop, same lunch table at Cardozo. (beat) She was a financial analyst. South Tower. A hundred and fourth floor. (beat) Sunday's four years.

Marc goes very still.

MARC
(quiet)
Harmony. I didn't know.

HARMONY
Nobody at the hospital knows. (beat) I don't talk about her. (beat) Her mama goes to the ceremony every year. They let the parents and the grandparents read the names this year. Mrs. Monroe's reading. (beat) I go and stand at the fence on Church Street. Every year. By myself.

A beat. She turns the card in her hands.

HARMONY
(carefully)
I never told her. (beat) How I felt. Not like a sister. (beat) I was going to tell her that weekend. We had brunch plans that Sunday. The sixteenth. (beat) And then there wasn't a sixteenth.

Marc looks at her. Understands. He reaches over and takes her hand.

HARMONY
(looking at their hands)
That's why I told Esther to run and find you yesterday. (beat) Because some things die unsaid, Marc. And then you carry them around in your pocket forever.

Her other hand drifts, just for a second, to her jacket pocket. Where the letter used to be. It's in her locker now. Her hand finds nothing and comes back.

MARC
(beat)
Can I come with you on Sunday?

Harmony looks at him for a long moment.

HARMONY
(barely)
I've never had anybody come with me.

MARC
(squeezing her hand)
Then this is the first year.

36 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - NIGHT
FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 9, 2005 - 11:20 PM

Esther sits at the little galley table with the bakery bag open in front of her, untouched. Her RAZR is at her ear.

CORINNE SMILLEY (V.O.)
(on the phone, fifty-seven, Roxbury steel)
Naomi told me he went to the boat.

ESTHER
(tired)
Naomi tells everybody everything, Mama.

CORINNE (V.O.)
That's why I gave birth to her first. So the rest of y'all could keep secrets. (beat) What's he want?

ESTHER
Thirty days. To talk.

CORINNE (V.O.)
(beat)
And the other one? The tall one Naomi says you've been seeing?

Esther closes her eyes.

ESTHER
(barely)
He told me the truth, Mama. And I didn't.

CORINNE (V.O.)
(beat)
Then you owe him the truth more than you owe Clayton a month. (beat) Baby. Listen to your mother. (beat) Talking isn't forgiving. You can talk to a man for thirty days and still walk away on the thirty-first. (beat) But you can't walk away from something you never looked at. You did that already, in February. Look where it got you.

Esther opens her eyes. She looks at the drawer under the galley: the ring, the tape-shaped hole where the MiniDV used to be.

ESTHER
(quiet)
I love you, Mama.

CORINNE (V.O.)
I know. (beat) Eat the rugelach.
I can hear you not eating it.

END OF ACT FIVE

TAG

37 EXT. LOWER MANHATTAN - CHURCH STREET - THE VIEWING FENCE AT THE WORLD TRADE CENTER SITE - MORNING
SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 11, 2005 - 8:44 AM

A gray-blue morning. The sixteen acres where the towers stood: a pit of concrete and cranes behind a chain-link fence lined with flowers, flags, photos and teddy bears. Thousands of people stand on Church Street in silence. On the big screens and speakers, the ceremony inside the site: parents and grandparents of the dead are reading the names.

Harmony, in a black dress, holds the laminated card. Marc stands beside her in a dark suit and tie. Neither of them speaks.

READER (V.O.)
(over the speakers, an elderly man's voice, reading from a list)
...and my grandson. And my son...

8:46. A bell tolls across Lower Manhattan. Thousands of people go silent at once. Even the traffic seems to stop. Harmony bows her head. Marc bows his.

MARC (V.O.)
Nobody tells you about the morning after. (beat) But some people live inside one forever.

The silence ends. The reading resumes. Harmony doesn't move.

9:03. The bell again: the second plane. The South Tower. Harmony's whole body goes rigid. Marc takes her hand. She grips it so hard her knuckles go pale.

MARC (V.O.)
They get up anyway. They put on a black dress, and they stand at a fence, and they read a name out loud. (beat) Every year.

On the speakers, a woman's voice, older, steady, a voice from Hollis, Queens: MRS. GWENDOLYN MONROE (V.O.).

GWENDOLYN MONROE (V.O.)
(over the speakers)
...and my daughter. Alicia Denise Monroe. (beat) Your mama loves you, baby. Every day.

Harmony makes a sound like something tearing. She turns into Marc's chest. He holds her. Around them, strangers move a little closer, the way New Yorkers do on this morning, without a word.

38 INT. QUEENS GRACE HOSPITAL - CARDIAC CARE UNIT - BED 6 - MORNING
SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 11, 2005 - 9:04 AM

Curtis Lemieux, sitting up, extubated, pink-cheeked, with a nineteen-year-old's heart on the monitor. The muted TV shows the ceremony. Amond, on weekend rounds, stands at the foot of the bed with the chart. He's holding his side again. He thinks nobody can see.

CURTIS
(watching the screen)
My mama's in Houston watching this too. (beat) Everybody's got somebody they're standing at a fence for, baby doctor.

Amond looks at the TV. Then down at his own hand pressed against his right side.

AMOND
(quiet)
Yes, sir.

39 INT. THE CLARENCE - CABIN - MORNING
SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 11, 2005 - 9:06 AM

Esther, in a black T-shirt, sits on the V-berth with a small TV playing the ceremony. She has just finished crying. Her RAZR is in her hand.

MARC (V.O.)
And some people spend the whole morning after trying to decide which way to walk.

She types.

SMS, to 617-555-0144: "30 days. starting tomorrow. talking only. a counselor i choose. that's all this is."

She sends it. The reply comes almost instantly.

SMS, from 617-555-0144: "Thank you, Es. Tomorrow. -C"

Esther puts the phone face down. She looks at the drawer under the galley.

Then she picks the phone back up. She opens a new message. To: MARC. She types: "i told him 30 days of talking. i wanted you to hear it from me first this time."

Her thumb hovers over SEND for a long, long moment.

She sends it.

40 EXT. LOWER MANHATTAN - CHURCH STREET - MORNING
SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 11, 2005 - 9:07 AM

In Marc's suit pocket, his phone buzzes once. He doesn't take it out. Harmony is still holding on to him, and he's still holding her.

MARC (V.O.)
First this time.

The names keep being read. The bell will toll twice more before ten-thirty. Marc stays exactly where he is.

MARC (V.O.)
It's a start. (beat) It's not a finish.

FADE OUT.

END OF EPISODE

Media Companion: Episode 2x01 (Season 2 Premiere)

Off-screen media around the episode, in chronological order. Not counted in page length (MA-009 §5).

QueensGraceConfidential (Blogger)

Friday, September 9, 2005, 12:31 AM

"Okay. We've got it now. At 7:02 PM, outside L&D;, the new fetal surgeon from Boston (handsome, Harvard, a blazer that costs more than our rent) introduced himself to Dr. X as the HUSBAND of Boston. As in married. As in, Boston is a Mrs. Witnesses say Dr. X said something very polite and walked away. Nobody got punched. Nobody yelled. Somehow that's worse. Boston, we liked you. We're going to need a minute." Comments (788).

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS: "QUEENS SCAFFOLD COLLAPSE INJURES TWO BROTHERS"

Saturday, September 10, 2005

"Two brothers working on the same Long Island City high-rise were seriously injured yesterday when a scaffold platform gave way 22 feet above Center Blvd., officials said. Lonnie Mayfield, 38, was impaled by a length of reinforcing bar, and his brother Otis, 41, suffered a head injury. Both were in stable condition at Queens Grace Hospital last night. The city Buildings Department issued a stop-work order and is investigating..."

ASSOCIATED PRESS: "FEMA CHIEF BROWN RELIEVED OF KATRINA DUTIES"

Friday, September 9, 2005

"WASHINGTON (AP) -- FEMA Director Michael Brown was abruptly removed today from his role overseeing the Hurricane Katrina relief effort and ordered back to Washington, as criticism of the federal response mounted. Coast Guard Vice Adm. Thad Allen will take over the on-site operation..."

NY1: on-screen chyron

Friday, September 9, 2005, 10:15 AM

"KATRINA EVACUEES ARRIVE AT JFK; QUEENS HOSPITALS TAKE IN DOZENS"

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Raven Ellison: phone tree)

Friday, September 9, 2005, 2:12 PM

To Harmony, Arianna, Amond: "EMERGENCY HOUSE DINNER 9PM. 49TH AVE. bring something. do NOT say her name. do NOT say husband. do NOT say boston. just eat"

Arianna: "bringing beer"

Amond: "Define 'something.'"

Raven: "ANYTHING AMOND"

Amond: "Understood."

(He brought ice.)

Victor Donohue Foundation: Pediatric Chronic Care Bridge Fund, first-week report

Friday, September 9, 2005

"In its first 24 hours, the Bridge Fund supplied insulin, glucagon and testing supplies to 1,214 displaced children in 19 states, and inhalers to 3,880 more. No medical records were required. Queens Grace Hospital (Long Island City) opened the first hospital-based Bridge Fund pharmacy in New York."

CNN.com: "NATION PAUSES FOR 9/11 ANNIVERSARY"

Sunday, September 11, 2005

"NEW YORK (CNN) -- Parents and grandparents of those killed at the World Trade Center read the victims' names aloud Sunday at ground zero, as the nation marked the fourth anniversary of the September 11 attacks. Bells tolled at 8:46 a.m. and 9:03 a.m., the moments the hijacked planes struck the twin towers, and again at the times the towers fell..."

AIM: away message, DoubleOHarmony (Harmony Divine)

Sunday, September 11, 2005, 7:30 AM

"A.D.M. 3/8/79 - 9/11/01. Four years. Not going to the fence alone this year."

SMS, Motorola RAZR (Esther Smilley to Marc-Anthony Bullock)

Sunday, September 11, 2005, 9:07 AM

Esther: "i told him 30 days of talking. i wanted you to hear it from me first this time"

(Read 11:52 AM. No reply.)

Continuity Sheet: Episode 2x01 (Season 2 Premiere)

New Canon Established

- **Picks up in the same second as 1x09** (7:02 PM, Thursday, September 8, 2005). Clayton gives the wedding details: Ocean Park gazebo, Oak Bluffs, Saturday, August 21, 2004, about 200 guests; Esther wore Corinne's veil. **Marc does not crash out.** He chooses quiet ('It's a warning. For me.') and walks away, refusing Natasha's 'My office.' This is Dr. Wise's lesson put into practice; MA-001 Rule 9 is honored, since he's at full strength and in full control.
- **Esther's full disclosure to Marc** (1:40 PM, Friday, On-Call Room 3): she met Clayton at 21 at a Jack and Jill gala in Boston. She found Clayton in their bed with Malcolm Sloan on **February 11, 2005** (new canon: the 18th anniversary of Clarence Smilley's murder), left that night by train with one suitcase, changed her number twice and never filed. Marc: 'A drawer's not a divorce.' 'I'm not going to be the drawer you put me in while you decide.' **Marc and Esther are not together** as of September 9.
- **The 'FOR MARC' MiniDV tape** (recorded August 8, 2005; 41 seconds) is now in Marc's possession. Esther left it on the stoop at 11:52 PM, September 8.
- **Clayton's 30 days:** he asks for September (30 days of talking and counseling with a counselor Esther chooses) and promises to sign the divorce without a fight if she still wants out. Esther agrees by text at 9:06 AM, September 11, starting Monday, September 12. **She tells Marc first** by text at 9:07 AM; he read it at 11:52 AM and hasn't replied. This is the counterpart arc of Derek and Addison's attempt (Grey's Season 2).
- **Clayton suspects Marc is the Chief's son** ('He has your hands'; 'I know what money sounds like when it's whispering'). He does not know about Victor. Monty, Natasha and Marc all deflected ('Bullock's a common name').
- **Amond's diagnosis** (R-4 adaptation of Cristina's pregnancy and ectopic arc): an inflamed 4 cm **Meckel's diverticulum with ectopic gastric mucosa** (positive technetium-99m Meckel's scan) and one episode of dark stool. Dr. Lowery recommended laparoscopic resection Monday; Amond deferred it to **Friday, October 14, 2005**. Robert, Lowery and Arianna know, and so does Miss Hattie (in general terms). Lowery: any fever, black stool or syncope means surgery that day. **Planned payoff:** the Meckel's bleeds or perforates before October 14 (the counterpart of Cristina's ectopic rupture), and Amond recovers fully with no lasting effect, per the No-Nerf rule.
- **Robert and Natasha's backstory:** after the Georgia Avenue diner (fall 1976), Robert didn't speak to her for three weeks. Natasha came to Founders Library and said, 'I'm not going to apologize for my father. I'm going to apologize for waiting.'
- **Harmony's Alicia:** Alicia Denise Monroe (March 8, 1979 - September 11, 2001), South Tower, 104th floor. Alicia and Harmony grew up three houses apart in Hollis and went to Cardozo High School. They had brunch plans for Sunday, September 16, 2001, when Harmony meant to tell her. Gwendolyn Monroe read Alicia's name at the 2005 ceremony. **Marc went to the fence with Harmony**, the first time she hasn't gone alone. Harmony's letter to Marc is still in her locker.

- **Natasha and Esther** had a confrontation over Policy 4.12 ('You hired my husband, Dr. Donohue'). Esther filed the form marked MARRIED. Clayton won't supervise Esther, and Esther isn't on Marc's or Clayton's service.
- **Raven and Arianna:** their first real partnership, on Alphonse Broussard. This is a seed for their future relationship (MA-005: married in 2009).
- **Beignet** (Dorian Batiste's dog) arrived via a Foundation-arranged transport to Teterboro, escorted by Big Ray. Dorian was discharged with Bridge Fund supplies.
- **Corinne Smilley** (heard on the phone): 'Talking isn't forgiving.' Naomi gave Clayton the marina address.

Knowledge Tracker (as of September 11, 2005)

Secret	Who knows	Who doesn't
Marc's family (Natasha and Robert's son, Elxa's brother)	Family, Bernie, Graves, Gloria, Mrs. Truitt, Amond, Big Ray, Arianna, Esther, Monty (suspects)	Raven, Harmony, Kendra, Deb; Clayton **suspects** he is the Chief's son
Marc is Victor Donohue's grandson	As above, minus Monty	Clayton, Raven, Harmony, the press; Julian Whitmore
Esther is married to Clayton	Now the whole hospital (the blog, 12:31 AM, September 9)	-
Clayton slept with Malcolm Sloan	Esther, Clayton, Malcolm; **Marc** (told September 9)	Everyone else at QGH
Harmony loves Marc	Raven, Esther	Marc (he knows about Alicia now, not about himself)
Amond's Meckel's diverticulum	Robert, Lowery, Arianna	Everyone else, including Marc

Patient Registry

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Yolanda Price (twins)	3/30/1974 (31)	Stage III TTTS	Fetoscopic laser ablation, 15 anastomoses (Clayton; Natasha), 7:41-9:15 PM, Sept 8	Both twins alive post-procedure
Lonnie Mayfield	2/3/1967 (38)	Rebar impalement, left thigh to lower abdomen; two small-bowel holes	Ex-lap, vascular control, rebar removal, bowel repair (Elxa; Marc; Robert)	Stable; iliac vessels spared
Otis Mayfield	7/19/1964 (41)	Acute epidural hematoma (middle meningeal artery); herniating	Craniotomy and evacuation (Graves; Esther)	Extubated, neuro intact
Patrice Dunmore	5/8/1969 (36)	Placenta percreta (into bladder serosa), 34 weeks, 5th cesarean	Cesarean hysterectomy, placenta left in situ (Clayton; Natasha; Harmony)	4 units; son Joshua, 4 lb 11 oz, NICU

Patient	DOB / age	Diagnosis	Procedure / surgeon	Outcome
Alphonse Broussard	1/22/1928 (77)	ESRD, 13 days without dialysis; K+ 7.9 with ECG changes	Calcium, insulin and glucose, albuterol; temporary catheter; emergent hemodialysis (Dr. Colbert; Arianna, Raven)	Agreed to dialysis until May 2007
Amond Baker	2/10/1979 (26)	Meckel's diverticulum, 4 cm, ectopic gastric mucosa	Lap resection scheduled 10/14/2005 (Lowery)	Deferred by patient

New Characters (to add to MA-005 and MA-006)

- **Lonnie Mayfield** (b. February 3, 1967) and **Otis Mayfield** (b. July 19, 1964), Ironworkers Local 40 brothers; **Charmaine Mayfield** (b. December 1, 1968), a Duane Reade pharmacist, Lonnie's ex-wife (divorced 1996) and Otis's wife (married 1997). **Walt Briscoe** (b. 1950), foreman.
- **Patrice Dunmore** (b. May 8, 1969), a choir director; **Rev. Gerald Dunmore** (b. March 3, 1965), a storefront pastor in South Ozone Park; son **Joshua** (b. September 9, 2005).
- **Alphonse Broussard** (b. January 22, 1928), a Korean War veteran (Purple Heart) from North Robertson Street, Tremé; wife **Odette Delacroix Broussard** (deceased, buried St. Louis Cemetery No. 2); granddaughter **Celestine Broussard** (b. 1984), a Dillard nursing student displaced to Spelman.
- **Dr. Nadine Colbert** (b. 1972), nephrology fellow, QGH. **Gwendolyn Monroe** (b. October 10, 1951), Alicia's mother (voice). **Corinne Smilley** makes her series debut (voice).

Real-World Accuracy Notes

- September 9, 2005: FEMA Director Michael Brown was removed from Katrina relief operations and replaced on site by Coast Guard Vice Adm. Thad Allen. Evacuees were flown from Houston to cities including New York. Dillard University closed for fall 2005, and its students enrolled at other schools. September 11, 2005 (a Sunday): at the fourth-anniversary ceremony, parents and grandparents read the names, with bells and silence at 8:46, 9:03, 9:59 and 10:29 AM. The public watched from the viewing fence on Church Street. Gantry Plaza's Pepsi-Cola sign and the Queens West towers on Center Boulevard are period-accurate.
- Medicine: a laser for TTTS is delivered through a fetoscope of about 2 mm. Severe hyperkalemia with ECG changes is treated with calcium gluconate, insulin and dextrose, albuterol and urgent hemodialysis; a patient with capacity may refuse dialysis. Placenta percreta: planned cesarean hysterectomy with the placenta left in situ. Meckel's diverticulum follows the 'rule of twos'; ectopic gastric mucosa shows up on a technetium-99m pertechnetate scan and can ulcerate, bleed or perforate. Penetrating rebar is left in place until it can be removed in the OR under vascular control. A middle meningeal artery epidural hematoma with herniation needs emergent evacuation.